Your Return-to-Duty Roadmap

Getting out of prohibited status after a DOT drug or alcohol violation

A violation places a CDL driver in prohibited status in the FMCSA Drug & Alcohol Clearinghouse. You cannot perform safety-sensitive duties, including driving a commercial motor vehicle, until the full SAP process is complete. Here is how it works.

1 **Register and designate your SAP**
Create or log in to your account at clearinghouse.fmcsa.dot.gov and designate Dr. Cherich as your Substance Abuse Professional (SAP).

2 **Initial SAP evaluation**
A clinical evaluation, in person or remote (TN and VA). You receive a written recommendation for education, treatment or both.

3 **Complete the recommended program**
Attend the education or treatment program. Keep proof of completion.

4 **Follow-up SAP evaluation**
Dr. Cherich confirms you have complied and reports your eligibility for return-to-duty testing to the Clearinghouse.

5 **Return-to-duty test**
Your employer arranges a directly observed return-to-duty test. A negative result is reported to the Clearinghouse, which ends prohibited status.

6 **Follow-up testing plan**
Expect unannounced follow-up tests set by the SAP: at least six in the first 12 months, and possibly continuing for up to five years.

What to have ready for your first appointment

- ☐ Your CDL number and state of issuance
- ☐ Your Clearinghouse login, with Dr. Cherich designated as your SAP
- ☐ The date and type of violation, and any paperwork from your employer or testing program
- ☐ Fee: [SAP EVALUATION PRICE]

Employers: Dr. Cherich works with companies that need a qualified SAP for their DOT drug and alcohol programs. Call to set up referrals.

Ready to start? Call 301-956-3185 or visit cherishconsulting.com/dot-evaluations. Remote evaluations available in Tennessee and Virginia.

Process defined by DOT regulations at 49 CFR Part 40, Subpart O. Timelines depend on the recommended program. This guide is general information, not legal advice.